

Outlook

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Follow-up: A decline is only the first event; what did the customer do next?

Hi team,

The same decline code can lead to a successful retry, an ATM attempt, a phone call or lost activity.

This has returned because the previous answer was useful but not strong enough to become a standing rule. Use August 2021 as the new evidence point rather than recycling the earlier conclusion. The operating teams agree that more journeys are failing; they disagree on whether the customer, the bank or a downstream party owns the failure.

Can you test these explanations rather than choosing one at the start?

- repeat declines cluster by card state or channel
- poor explanations drive complaints more than the decline itself
- most declines recover immediately

The decision is which decline reasons need rule, message or service changes. Please give us a one-page finding note plus the underlying CSV for our own review.

You should be able to build the evidence from transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions. The data does not contain merchant terminal logs or card-scheme dispute outcomes.

Thanks